

Adding and Subtracting Mixed Numbers

Adding mixed numbers with like denominators, subtracting mixed numbers by regrouping, and rewriting with a common denominator before adding or subtracting

Before you start.

- Add or subtract the whole numbers and the fraction parts separately, then put the two results back together.
- Fractions can only be combined when the denominators match. If they do not, rewrite both fractions with a common denominator first.
- If the fraction part of a sum is bigger than one whole, trade it for a whole and keep the rest.
- If the fraction you are subtracting is bigger than the one you have, regroup: take one whole from the whole-number part and add it to the fraction.
- Write your answer in simplest form, with the unit the story uses.

1. Rosa walked $2\frac{3}{8}$ miles before lunch and $1\frac{1}{8}$ miles after lunch. How far did she walk in all?

Answer: _____ miles

2. A recipe uses $1\frac{5}{12}$ cups of orange juice and $3\frac{1}{12}$ cups of apple juice. How much juice does the recipe use altogether?

Answer: _____ cups

3. Devon practised piano for $2\frac{5}{6}$ hours on Saturday and $1\frac{4}{6}$ hours on Sunday. How many hours did he practise over the two days? Give your answer in simplest form.

Answer: _____ hours

4. A bag of birdseed held $5\frac{1}{4}$ pounds. A gardener poured out $2\frac{3}{4}$ pounds. How many pounds of birdseed are left in the bag?

Answer: _____ pounds

5. A pitcher held some water. After $3\frac{2}{5}$ cups were poured out, $4\frac{3}{5}$ cups were still in the pitcher. Write an equation with a letter for the starting amount, then find how many cups the pitcher held at the start.

Answer: _____ cups

6. A soup pot already holds $1\frac{1}{2}$ cups of broth. A cook adds $2\frac{1}{3}$ cups more. How much broth is in the pot now?

Answer: _____ cups

7. A bike path is $4\frac{3}{4}$ miles long. Priya has ridden $1\frac{2}{3}$ miles of it. How much of the path does she still have to ride?

Answer: _____ miles

8. A rain barrel held $7\frac{1}{6}$ gallons. After a gardener used some of the water, $3\frac{5}{6}$ gallons were left. Write an equation with a letter for the amount used, then find how many gallons were used.

Answer: _____ gallons

9. Sam had to find $6\frac{1}{8} - 2\frac{5}{8}$ for the length of a piece of trim, in inches. He wrote $4\frac{4}{8}$ inches. Explain in one sentence what Sam did wrong in the fraction column, then find the correct length in simplest form.

Answer: _____ inches

10. A bread recipe calls for $3\frac{1}{4}$ cups of flour. Ana has only $1\frac{2}{3}$ cups in the jar. How many more cups of flour does she need? Show the common denominator you used.

Answer: _____ cups